



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cary Christian School

School Website: <https://carychristianschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit: Bishop Ryan Catholic School (Minot, ND)

Website audited: <https://bishopryan.com/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- What we can verify from the crawl: the school publicly frames its work around virtue and formation in a Catholic context. The homepage title says "Inspired Minds. Faithful Hearts. Lives of Virtue." and at least one internal section is labeled "Human Formation."
- Strengths: Clear theological identity and moral/virtue emphasis align with classical aims in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal. These align with positive indicators such as virtue, faith/theology, and formation drawn from the Six Elements keyword lists and lexicon.
- Gaps: The crawl (blocked by CAPTCHA in many places) did not yield public statements about the curriculum (Trivium, Great Books, Latin), pedagogy (Socratic seminar, chanting, scholé), faculty profile, or parent partnership. Absent evidence leads to low coverage and "Not Classical" ratings in Categories 3–6 for now.

Because the site copy accessible in the crawl primarily evidences Categories 1–2 (and we lack verifiable details for Categories 3–6), the aggregate is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL pending more publicly available detail.

Method

- Framework: "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" keyword indicators (positive/negative) and classicality lexicon across six categories.
- Sources: Firecrawl JSON from bishopryan.com (homepage titles and limited page headers due to CAPTCHA), including:
 - Homepage title: "Inspired Minds. Faithful Hearts. Lives of Virtue."
 - "Why Choose Bishop Ryan?" (page title only)
 - "Apply for 2025-2026... Minot, ND" (page title; also captures "Human Formation" header in body nav)

For each category below, we first list keywords captured from the school's public materials, compare to the positive/negative indicators, quantify hits, then assign a rating.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- 1) Keywords found on school site
 - “Catholic” (school name), “Faithful Hearts,” “Lives of Virtue,” “Human Formation.”
 - 2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon
 - Positive indicators include virtue, theology/faith, and (ideally) liturgical practices (Mass/chapel). The site’s visible phrases align strongly to virtue and faith/theology but we could not verify liturgical language from the crawl (CAPTCHA).
 - 3) Quantification (positive vs. negative keyword hits)
 - Positive hits: 4 (Catholic, Faithful, Virtue, Formation)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Estimated coverage of sub-criteria (transcendentals, theology, liturgy): 2 of 3 (~67%) given no accessible evidence of liturgy/Mass
 - Percent_positive: 100%; pos_neg_hits: +4/-0
 - 4) Rating
 - CLASSICAL (content clearly signals theological ground and virtue-formation, though liturgical practices weren’t visible in the crawl).
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- 1) Keywords found on school site
 - “Lives of Virtue,” “Human Formation.”
 - 2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon
 - Positive indicators include formation, cultivation of virtue, and pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful. We see direct formation/virtue language; the TGB phrasing is not visible in the crawl.
 - 3) Quantification
 - Positive hits: 2 (virtue, formation)
 - Negative hits: 0 (no “college-and-career-ready”/21st-century-skills language captured)
 - Coverage of sub-criteria (virtue/wisdom; formation; TGB): 2 of 3 (~67%)
 - Percent_positive: 100%; pos_neg_hits: +2/-0
 - 4) Rating
 - CLASSICAL (clear formation/virtue purpose; TGB not verified in the captured content).
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- 1) Keywords found on school site
 - None verifiable from the crawl for Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary sources, Latin/Greek, history vs. “social studies,” integration/wonder (CAPTCHA limited content).
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon
 - Positive indicators include the Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and history by name (not “social studies”). Negative indicators include exclusive emphasis on project-based/skills-forward language. The crawl yielded neither positive nor negative curriculum signals.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0
- Coverage of sub-criteria: 0 of 4 (0%)
- Percent_positive: 0%; pos_neg_hits: +0/-0

4) Rating

- NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient public evidence).
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

1) Keywords found on school site

- None verifiable from the crawl (no evidence of Socratic seminar, chanting/memorization, scholé/restful learning, or rhetoric/orations).

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators include Socratic dialogue, chanting/recitation, scholé, and rhetoric/oratory. None were visible in the captured content.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0
- Coverage: 0 of 4 (0%)
- Percent_positive: 0%; pos_neg_hits: +0/-0

4) Rating

- NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient public evidence).
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found on school site

- None verifiable from the crawl (no “teachers as mentors,” “living curriculum,” or faculty portraits/profiles of a teacher/student).

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators include teachers as models of virtue and mentoring/collegial culture. Not visible in the captured content.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0
- Coverage: 0%
- Percent_positive: 0%; pos_neg_hits: +0/-0

4) Rating

- NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient public evidence).
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- 1) Keywords found on school site
 - None verifiable from the crawl (no explicit “parent partnership,” “co-educators,” or parent formation).
 - 2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon
 - Positive indicators include partnership with parents and formation of affections/community culture; none were visible in the captured content.
 - 3) Quantification
 - Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0
 - Coverage: 0%
 - Percent_positive: 0%; pos_neg_hits: +0/-0
 - 4) Rating
 - NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient public evidence).
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Aggregate Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Verified classical signals: Element 1 (religious/theological orientation and virtue) and Element 2 (formation/virtue aims) align with the Six Elements positive indicators for transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, and formation/virtue-centric goals.
 - Insufficient evidence (due to CAPTCHA-limited crawl) across Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community prevents a fully classical designation at this time.
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What would move the needle (recommended next steps)

To reach an unequivocal CLASSICAL rating, ensure the following are explicitly presented and easily discoverable on public pages:

- Curriculum
 - State the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and, if applicable, Quadrivium, as organizing principles; list Latin (and any Greek) requirements; name Great Books/primary texts and “Great Conversation” aims.
 - Refer to “History” explicitly (avoid collapsing it into “Social Studies”) and emphasize chronological study and Western civilization engagement.
- Pedagogy
 - Describe lower-school memory work (singing/chanting/recitation) and upper-school Socratic seminars, dialectic/debate, and rhetoric/orations/capstones; mention restful learning/scholé where relevant.
- Faculty
 - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” highlighting teachers as models/mentors of wisdom and virtue—the “living curriculum.”
- Parents & Community
 - Emphasize parent partnership/co-educators and parent education (book clubs, seminars), and hospitality/open campus norms.

If these elements already exist internally, consider surfacing them on public pages not blocked by CAPTCHA to improve verifiability.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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